

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 9 8 3

♥ 9 8 3

♦ K J 5

♣ 6 2

♠ J 7

♥ A Q 7 2

♦ 8 3

♣ J 10 9 7 5



♠ Q 5 2

♥ J 10 6 4

♦ Q 10 4

♣ K 8 3

♠ K 6 4

♥ K 5

♦ A 9 7 6 2

♣ A Q 4

West	North	East	South
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Pass

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

♠K at the first trick.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

Not only do you need 3 more winners, you need to get them without losing the lead because the instant you lose the lead West will take all his ♠ winners. You can **HOPE** that will only be 3 of them but you can't depend on it.

The ♣ suit is your only hope. If East holds the ♣K you can finesse him out of it. However, if he has ♣ K x x and refuses to cover your ♣J, you will have to have a second entry to dummy to cash the good ♣s.

As it happens, you do have two entries, the ♥A and ♥Q! You just have to sacrifice your ♥K to use them both. At trick 2 play your small ♥ to the ♥Q. Play the ♣J, letting it ride when East plays low. Play a small ♣ to your ♣Q. Play the ♣A, dropping East's ♣K. And finally, play your ♥K to dummy's ♥A so you can enjoy cashing those two good ♣s.

Bridge is a nice game.

You sacrifice one sure ♥ winner to create a second dummy entry which creates two ♣ winners.

With 9 points you are in the game-invitational range. And with a 4-card ♥ suit you should use Stayman. You bid 2♣ and partner says 2♦. What is your next bid?

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You are still in game-invitational range, but now you invite partner with 2NT. He replies 3NT and that ends the bidding.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠10. You cross your fingers and put on dummy's ♠J. No good, East covers with the ♠Q and you are forced to take your

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6 3
♥ K 10 6 3
♦ 7 6 3
♣ 9 7 2

♠ J 9 4

♥ 8 7 5

♦ A Q J 2

♣ K 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 5 2

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ 8 5 4

♣ A 8 5

♠ A Q 10 8

♥ A 2

♦ K 10 9

♣ Q J 10 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South
get them in ♠s if East holds the ♠K, a 50% chance.

You should try to avoid 50% chances when you have something better. Consider the chance that EW will actually be able to win 4 ♥ tricks if you give them the lead with the ♣A. In particular notice that you were dealt the ♥2! If West's ♥3 is a fourth down lead then he cannot have anything smaller and the ♥s are splitting 4-4.

Knowing they can only take 3 ♥ tricks makes it safe for you to drive out the ♣A.

So win the ♥A and drive out the ♣A. They will take their 2 ♥ tricks next. If East then leads a ♠ **DO NOT FINESSE**. Take your nine tricks and run.

The question to consider about this Deal is whether to trust your opponents, in particular whether you can trust them to be leading fourth highest.

While the answer may depend on the opponent, usually you should take their opening lead at face value. After all, their main goal is to give information to their partner, not to deceive you.

Partner has about 11 points and he has no 4-card Major suit.

He thinks 3NT would be a good spot. You have no reason to disagree so you pass.

South plays 3NT; West leads the ♥3.

East plays the ♥J and you duck, hoping he will switch to any other suit! But of course he doesn't; he continues with the ♥4.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 4 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 6

You need three more winners. You can get them in ♣s by just driving out the ♣A. The danger is that EW might win the ♣A and 4 ♥ tricks. Or, you can